

PATTERN RETAIL

Brand Style Guide

Visual identity, voice and data-viz standards for client and internal deliverables

VERSION

1.0

ISSUED

May 2026

OWNER

Pattern Retail Ops

APPLIES TO

All client-facing reports, decks, documents and dashboards



Drop a copy of this guide into every project folder. It is the source of truth for how Pattern Retail looks, reads and reports.

The Pattern Retail brand at a glance

Pattern Retail builds stock allocation and business intelligence software for retailers. Our brand reads the way our products work: clear, structured, signal-led — never decorative. Every artefact, from the monthly Project Status Report to a one-page client email, follows the same small set of rules so that anything from Pattern looks unmistakably from Pattern.

Five principles

- Clarity over completeness — every artefact should answer one question.
- Forward visibility over historical reporting — we look at the next nine weeks, not the last.
- Signal, not decoration — no drop shadows, side ribbons, or full-width colour bars.
- Mango is a cue, not a fill — used as a thin accent strip, never as a background.
- Tables over paragraphs — show the data, then write one line that explains it.

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Brand cue and logo system

Pattern Retail does not rely on a heavy logo lockup. The brand reads through a single, consistent cue: a mango block in the top-right corner of every slide, and a thin mango accent strip on a small set of structural elements. That is the whole system.

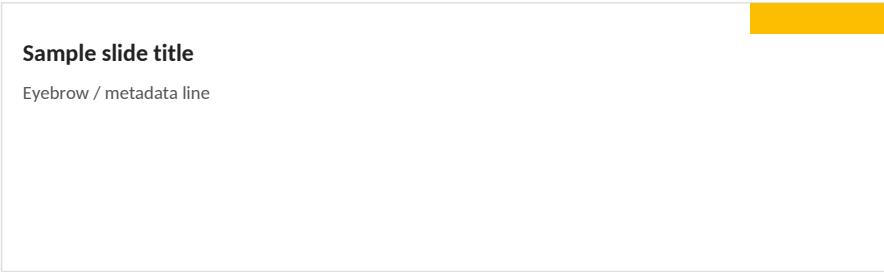
Where the mango accent strip is allowed

- Left edge of Executive Summary KPI tiles.
- Left edge of Risks & Exceptions body rows.
- Left edge of Decisions Required card bodies (below the black header, not behind it).
- Left edge of any callout / pull-quote block in long-form documents.

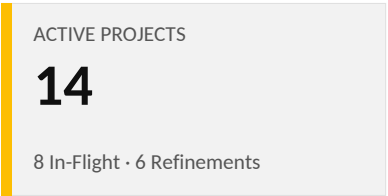
Where it is never used

- As a background fill, gradient, or full-width banner.
- Behind the black header bar of Decisions Required cards.
- Under slide titles as a decorative underline.
- Inside chart areas — phase and RAG palettes do that work.

DECK-WIDE CUE — TOP-RIGHT CORNER



ACCENT STRIP — KPI TILE



Colour — primary palette

Pattern Retail's working palette is small on purpose. Mango is the brand accent. Everything else is white, ink, and three weights of grey. Holding to this palette is the single biggest thing you can do to keep an artefact on-brand.

Mango

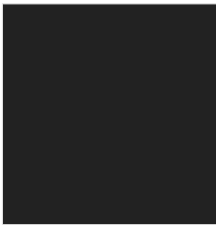
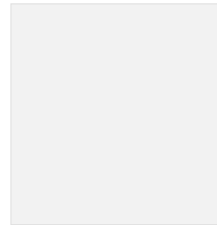
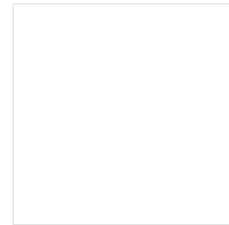
Brand accent — the cue that carries through every Pattern artefact.

HEX #FDBE02
RGB 253 • 190 • 2
CMYK 0 • 25 • 99 • 1

USE

- Top-right corner block — every slide.
- Left-edge strip — KPI tiles, Risk rows, Decision cards.
- Never as a background or full-width fill.

NEUTRAL PALETTE — INK & GREY

					
Ink	Ink 2	Ink 3	Grey Mid	Grey Light	White
#101010	#222222	#555555	#BDBDBD	#F2F2F2	#FFFFFF

Primary text • slide titles • black headers	Body text on white	Sub-text • eyebrows • footers	Group header bands only (Snapshot, Timeline)	KPI tile background	Slide and document base
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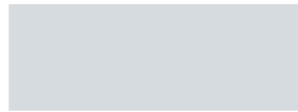
RULE

The neutral palette is what carries 95% of every Pattern artefact. Mango is the 5% — used as an accent, not a fill. Phase and RAG colours are reserved for the data layer (Gantt cells, RAG tints, chart bars), not the page chrome.

Colour — phase and RAG palettes

These palettes are reserved for the data layer: Gantt cells, phase tracking heat-maps, Forward View bar chart and RAG tint cells on tables. They are never used for slide chrome.

PHASE — FADED DELIVERY RENDER (USED ON THE GANTT)

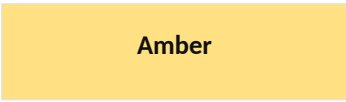
						
Discovery #D6E4FF	Implementation #F8D5FF	UAT #DCD0FF	Training #B5E8DD	Go-Live #FFF59D	Hypercare #C5D9E5	Project Admin #D6DBDF

PHASE — CANONICAL CLICKUP HEX (FIELD COLOURS IN CLICKUP, NOT THE DECK)

						
#81B1FF	#EA80FC	#7C4DFF	#1BBC9C	#FF7FAB	#3082B7	#667684

RAG — STATUS TINTS

Faded tint = cell fill on tables. Saturated hex = dots and saturated marks only. RAG label text remains black.

		
Green	Amber	Red
Faded #C8E6C9 Saturated #2E7D32	Faded #FFE082 Saturated #F9A825	Faded #FFCDD2 Saturated #C62828

DATA-COLOUR RULE
Phase colour and RAG tint never appear on the same cell. Gantt cells use phase colour; Phase Tracking and Health Summary cells use RAG tint. Don't mix them.

Typography

Pattern Retail uses Calibri across every artefact. One typeface, one weight system, one set of sizes. No display fonts, no italic-only headers, no condensed variants.

TYPEFACE

Calibri

Regular · Bold · Italic — that's the whole family we use.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

TYPE SCALE

ROLE	STYLE	WHERE
Cover title	Bold 56pt	Cover only.
Slide title	Bold 26–28pt	Every standard slide.
KPI value	Bold 22pt	Big numbers on Exec Summary.
Heading	Bold 12pt	Section headings inside body copy.
Body	Regular 10–11pt	Paragraph copy, document body.
Table body	Regular 8.5pt	Snapshot, Health Summary cells.
Eyebrow / footer	Regular 7.5–9pt	Metadata, slide numbers, footers.

TYPE RULES

- Body copy is regular weight. Bold is reserved for titles, table headers, and the first line of any KPI value.
- Italic is reserved for the 'Decision: ...' ask line on Decisions Required cards. Don't use italic for emphasis elsewhere.
- Don't underline. Use a hairline rule beneath titles instead.
- ALL CAPS is reserved for eyebrows, table column headers, and tiny labels (≤ 9pt). Never set body copy or titles in caps.
- Line length: aim for 70–90 characters on body paragraphs. On slides, one idea per line wherever possible.

Tone of voice and writing style

Pattern Retail writes the way our reports work. Direct, structured, signal-led. Readers should be able to skim a page and pick up the call without reading every word.

Voice	ATTRIBUTES	Do	WRITE LIKE THIS	Don't	AVOID THIS
	Plain. Short sentences. Active verbs. No corporate verbiage. Confident, but not promotional. We describe what is, not what we hope. Specific. Use names, dates, numbers. 'UAT slipped to 19 May' beats 'UAT delayed slightly'. Calm. Even when the news is red, the tone is steady. The data does the alarm. Internally British English (analyse, organisation, behaviour). Match the client where needed.		Lead with the call. 'Algorithm deployment slips one week; UAT 01 Jun still on plan.' Expand acronyms on first use. 'User Acceptance Testing (UAT)'. Use explicit dates, not 'next week'. 'W3 / 12 May'. One idea per bullet. One bullet per line. End decision asks with the word 'Decision:' followed by the explicit call. Use 'Implementation', not 'build'. Use 'Customer', not 'Client' on portfolio slides.		Don't hedge. 'Could potentially be considered' = delete. Don't write status narrations. The table is the status. Don't use exclamation marks. Ever. Don't use 'TBC' on a date. Use '—' and flag the missing date on Risks & Exceptions. Don't use marketing words: 'leverage', 'best-in-class', 'robust'. Pick a real verb. Don't name individual owners on portfolio slides. The audience is the leadership body.

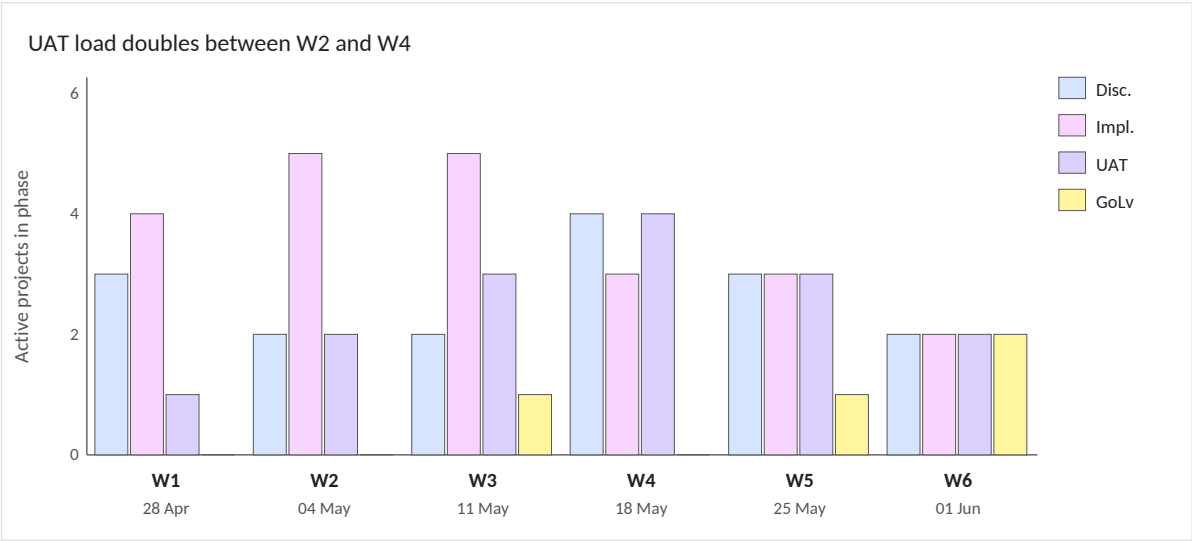
Data visualisation — charts

Charts at Pattern Retail are signal devices. Every chart answers a single question. If a chart needs a paragraph of explanation, it is the wrong chart.

Charting rules

- Axis labels mandatory. Every axis shows what it represents, including units. The Forward View Y-axis reads 'Active projects in phase'.
- Week labels: W# on top, Monday start date beneath ('W1 / 28 Apr'). Tight rule for tight space.
- Legend sits to the right of the chart, never inside the plot area.
- Bars use the faded delivery palette with slightly more saturation so they read on white. Go-Live stays pastel yellow #FFF59D.
- Use clustered columns for workload-by-phase-by-week. Avoid stacked bars — they hide single-phase load.
- No 3-D effects. No gradients. No drop shadows. Flat bars, clean borders.
- Three-bullet read-out beneath the chart. No more. 'What this tells us:' in bold above the bullets.

EXAMPLE — FORWARD VIEW (CLUSTERED COLUMNS)



What this tells us:

- Implementation peaks W2–W3, then drops as projects flow into UAT.
- UAT load doubles between W2 and W4 — testing capacity is the pinch point.
- First Go-Live in W3; second in W5 — cutover support needed both weeks.

Data visualisation — tables

Tables are Pattern's primary deliverable. They are not styled spreadsheets — they are designed shapes. Group structure, header treatment and RAG tints are the three things that have to be consistent across every table we ship.

PROJECT	CUSTOMER	CURRENT PHASE	KEY MILESTONE	NEXT PHASE (START)	RAG
In-Flight • 4 projects					
PnP MFP	Pick n Pay	UAT	UAT sign-off	Implementation (19 May)	Amber
Hertex Analytics	Hertex	Implementation	Data validation sign-off	UAT (12 May)	Green
Mr Price Alloc	Mr Price	Discovery	SOW sign-off	Implementation (04 May)	Green
Truworths MFP	Truworths	Hypercare	Project closure	Closure (24 Jun)	Red

Table rules

- Header row is solid Ink (#101010) with white text in ALL CAPS, bold, 9pt.
- Group rows span the full table width, use medium grey (#BDBDBD) and carry the group count inline ('In-Flight • 4 projects').
- Current Phase cell uses the faded phase palette as fill. Text stays black.
- RAG cell uses the faded RAG tint as fill. Text stays black. No coloured text.
- Row borders are hairline #E0E0E0. No alternating row shading.
- Dates use DD Mon format ('12 May'). Year is only added when the date crosses into the next year.
- Missing date → '—'. Never 'TBC'. The missing date is flagged on Risks & Exceptions.

Slide and document layout

Pattern slides follow the same skeleton every time. The cover sets the window, the Executive Summary leads with the call, and the eight slides that follow answer one question each. Long-form documents follow a parallel structure: eyebrow, title, body, accent strip on callouts.

ANATOMY OF A STANDARD SLIDE

EYEBROW · METADATA

Slide title goes here

Body — table, chart, or KPI tiles

Pattern Retail · Brand Style Guide · v1.0

Section label

n / N

Mango corner cue

1.6 × 0.36 inch, every slide

Title — Bold 26pt

Eyebrow above, hairline below

Body — one shape per slide

Table, chart, KPI grid or card grid

Footer — 7.5pt Ink 3

Hairline above

Layout rules

- One question per slide. If it answers two, split it.
- No decorative dividers, side ribbons, or full-width colour bars.
- No drop shadows on any shape — tiles, cards, bars, cells, Gantt blocks.
- Mango corner block is on every slide, always top-right, same size.
- Title sits in a fixed position; eyebrow and hairline make the title block read at a glance.
- Footer carries report identity, section label and page number — never absent.
- Long-form documents mirror the slide skeleton: eyebrow, bold title, hairline, body. Mango accent strip on callouts only.

Quick reference

Colour	Type	Files & filing
BRAND ACCENT Mango #FDBE02	TYPEFACE Calibri (Regular • Bold • Italic)	DECK FILENAME Project_Status_Report_YYYY_MM_DD.pptx
PRIMARY TEXT Ink #101010	COVER Bold 56pt	DOC FILENAME Project_Status_Report_Descriptor.docx
BODY TEXT Ink 2 #222222	SLIDE TITLE Bold 26–28pt	DATE FORMAT YYYY_MM_DD (sorts chronologically)
SUB TEXT Ink 3 #555555	KPI VALUE Bold 22pt	BRAND CUE Mango block top-right on every slide
GROUP BANDS Grey Mid #BDBDBD	HEADING Bold 12pt	ACCENT STRIP KPI tiles • Risk rows • Decision cards • Callouts
KPI BACKGROUND Grey Light #F2F2F2	BODY Regular 10–11pt	CHARTS Phase / RAG palette only inside the plot
HAIRLINE RULES Grey Hair #E0E0E0	TABLE BODY Regular 8.5pt	TABLES Ink header • Grey Mid group rows • Faded tints
PAGE BASE White #FFFFFF	FOOTER / EYEBROW Regular 7.5–9pt	TONE Specific. Calm. Forward-looking. No exclamation marks.
OWNERSHIP Pattern Retail Operations owns this guide. Send corrections or proposed additions to the Ops lead. The guide is reviewed quarterly; the change log is appended to the working framework document.		